

Bank of Leeds

Anglo-Futurist Masterplan for Scarborough 2031–2050

Rebuilding Britain's First Seaside Resort as Europe's Finest Coastal City

Prepared for

Bank of Leeds

Department for Strategic Development, Tourism & Coastal Investment

Classification

Strategic Urban Regeneration • Tourism • Commercial Property • Maritime Infrastructure • Hospitality

Programme Value

£4.8 Billion

Delivery Period

2031–2045

Executive Summary

By 2031, Yorkshire has entered a prolonged period of economic expansion driven by manufacturing, finance, tourism, clean energy and infrastructure investment.

The Bank of Leeds proposes the most ambitious seaside regeneration programme undertaken in Britain since the Victorian era:

The Scarborough Renaissance

Rather than attempting to recreate the traditional British seaside town, the proposal embraces **Anglo-Futurist principles**:

- classical architecture,
- modern infrastructure,
- maritime commerce,
- luxury tourism,
- technological innovation,

- civic beauty.

The objective is straightforward:

Restore Scarborough as Britain's premier seaside resort and establish it as the cultural capital of the Yorkshire coast.

Scarborough has a unique claim as Britain's first seaside resort, with the arrival of the railway in 1845 helping drive its Victorian expansion and landmarks such as the Grand Hotel becoming symbols of nineteenth-century tourism.

The Anglo-Futurist Principles

The redevelopment follows five principles.

Beauty

Buildings should inspire pride.

Permanence

Infrastructure should last centuries.

Prosperity

Tourism must generate wealth throughout the year.

Public Space

The waterfront belongs to pedestrians.

Yorkshire Identity

Everything should unmistakably feel Yorkshire.

Total Investment

Programme	Investment
New Seafront	£800m
Grand Hotel restoration	£250m
Marina & small commercial port	£450m
Streetcar system	£650m
Hospitality & casinos	£600m
Commercial property	£700m
Housing	£500m
Cultural & sporting facilities	£350m
Public realm & parks	£300m

Programme	Investment
Contingency	£200m
Total	

£4.8 Billion

1. The Great Promenade

The existing promenade becomes one of Europe's finest public waterfronts.

Inspired by:

- Nice
- San Sebastián
- Copenhagen
- Brighton (at its Victorian peak)

The redevelopment includes:

- wide granite promenades,
- formal gardens,
- fountains,
- cafés,
- terraces,
- sculpture,
- covered colonnades.

Private cars are removed from the immediate waterfront, reflecting longstanding urban design ideas that prioritise pedestrians and public spaces along the seafront.

2. Restoration of the Grand Hotel

Investment

£250 million

The Grand Hotel becomes:

The Grand Yorkshire Hotel

A five-star flagship hotel.

Facilities include:

- 320 luxury rooms,

- ballroom,
- rooftop restaurant,
- spa,
- conference centre,
- heritage museum.

The Grade II* listed Grand Hotel was one of Europe's largest hotels when completed in 1867 and remains one of Scarborough's defining landmarks.

3. Scarborough Marina

Investment

£450 million

Construct a modern marina integrated with the existing harbour.

Facilities:

- 350 yacht berths,
- sailing academy,
- maritime museum,
- fish market,
- seafood restaurants,
- boutique retail.

Commercial facilities:

- small coastal freight,
- fishing fleet,
- maintenance yards.

The harbour becomes an active working waterfront rather than solely a visitor attraction.

4. Yorkshire Streetcar Network

Investment

£650 million

A modern tramway links the town's principal destinations.

Lines

Railway Station

↓

Town Centre

↓

South Bay

↓

Harbour

↓

Castle

↓

North Bay

↓

Open Air Theatre

↓

Peasholm Park

↓

North Bay Resort

Second line:

Station

↓

University

↓

Hospital

↓

Residential districts

Journey times:

Route	Current	Streetcar
Station → South Bay	18 min	6 min
Station → North Bay	22 min	8 min
Castle → Open Air Theatre	20 min	7 min

5. Yorkshire Casino Quarter

Investment

£300 million

A carefully planned entertainment district.

Facilities:

- boutique casinos,
- jazz clubs,
- theatres,
- whisky lounges,
- live music venues,
- rooftop cocktail bars.

The objective is to increase evening spending and encourage longer visitor stays.

6. Yorkshire Food Quarter

Investment

£200 million

Create Britain's largest regional food destination.

Permanent market featuring:

- Yorkshire cheeses,
- seafood,
- breweries,
- bakeries,
- chocolatiers,
- gin distilleries,
- tea merchants.

Restaurants focus on locally sourced produce.

7. The Yorkshire Cricket Festival

Investment

£120 million

Construct:

Scarborough Cricket Pavilion

A 10,000-seat venue overlooking the sea.

Programmes include:

- county cricket,
- international exhibition matches,
- The Yorkshire Twenty20 Festival,
- junior academies,
- annual corporate cricket week.

Scarborough already has a long association with first-class cricket through the historic Scarborough Cricket Festival, providing an established sporting tradition to build upon.

8. Residential Renaissance

Investment

£500 million

Construct:

- Georgian terraces,
- Victorian-inspired apartments,
- waterfront penthouses,
- artisan housing.

Target:

5,000 new residents.

9. Commercial Property Programme

Investment

£700 million

Develop:

- offices,
- hotels,
- retail arcades,
- innovation hub,
- maritime business centre.

Bank of Leeds establishes:

Scarborough Property Investment Fund

Acquiring strategic land before redevelopment.

Financial Returns

Commercial property portfolio:

Investment:

£700 million

Estimated completed value:

£1.25 billion

Rental income:

Approximately

£75 million annually

Tourism Growth

Current tourism remains heavily seasonal.

The objective:

Move towards year-round tourism.

Visitor growth:

Year	Visitors
2031	3.5 million
2038	5.0 million
2045	6.5 million

Average visitor expenditure:

£165

Tourism economy:

Approximately £1.1 billion annually

Employment

Construction

Approximately

18,000 job-years

Permanent employment

Sector	Jobs
Hospitality	4,000
Retail	2,200
Transport	700
Marina	600
Hotels	2,300
Property	1,200
Culture	1,000
Total	

12,000 permanent jobs

Property Value Uplift

Expected waterfront appreciation:

40–80%

Town centre commercial appreciation:

30–50%

Private investment attracted:

Approximately

£3 billion

Annual Economic Impact

Sector	Annual Contribution
Tourism	£1.1bn
Hospitality	£350m
Property	£150m
Marina	£100m

Sector	Annual Contribution
Conferences	£120m
Retail	£220m
Total annual economic activity:	

Approximately £2 billion

Financing

Scarborough Renaissance Bond

Initial Issue:

£3.5 billion

Supporting equity:

£1.3 billion

Funding:

Source	Amount
Bank of Leeds	£2.0bn
Pension funds	£1.0bn
Private developers	£1.0bn
Tourism & hospitality investors	£0.8bn

A New Identity

The redevelopment gives Scarborough a clear international identity:

"Britain's Grand Seaside City."

Rather than competing on low-cost tourism, Scarborough competes on:

- architecture,
 - heritage,
 - culture,
 - gastronomy,
 - maritime leisure,
 - premium hospitality.
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Final Investment Thesis

The Victorian entrepreneurs who built Scarborough understood that prosperity followed **railways, architecture and civic ambition**. The railway transformed the town into Britain's first mass-market seaside resort, while landmarks such as the Grand Hotel became symbols of confidence and permanence.

The Anglo-Futurist Masterplan seeks to apply those same principles to the twenty-first century.

The proposal is not simply about restoring historic buildings or constructing new infrastructure. It is about creating a coherent urban identity where transport, hospitality, maritime activity, sport, public space and private investment reinforce one another.

By 2045, Scarborough is envisioned as a prosperous coastal city where residents enjoy high-quality public spaces, businesses benefit from year-round visitor demand, and Yorkshire possesses a flagship seaside destination capable of attracting domestic and international visitors alike. The ambition is to make Scarborough once again a place that defines the British seaside experience—not through nostalgia alone, but through long-term investment, architectural quality and sustained economic growth.